

ALCHEMY ARCHITECT

Design the sound.

LISTEN: WHO DESIGNED THIS SOUND?

EVERY SOUND WAS DESIGNED

Someone built that sound, knob by knob

Teacher: play a short passage you choose, one with a bold synth sound.

- What does the sound make you think of?
- Is it smooth or rough, bright or dark?
- Does it change while the note plays?

FOUR BUILDING BLOCKS

- Oscillator: makes the raw wave
- Filter: cuts or boosts frequencies
- Envelope: shapes the sound over time
- Modulation: makes it move

SEVEN CLASSES

CLASS 1	Who designed this sound? · four building blocks · explore Alchemy
CLASS 2	Oscillator · filter · envelope · LFO · build Patch 1
CLASS 3	Working day: Patches 2 and 3
CLASS 4	Working day: compose with your patches
CLASS 5	Working day: compose and thicken
CLASS 6	Mix · bounce · checklist · rubric · 3 questions
CLASS 7	Presentations with Padlet Q&A

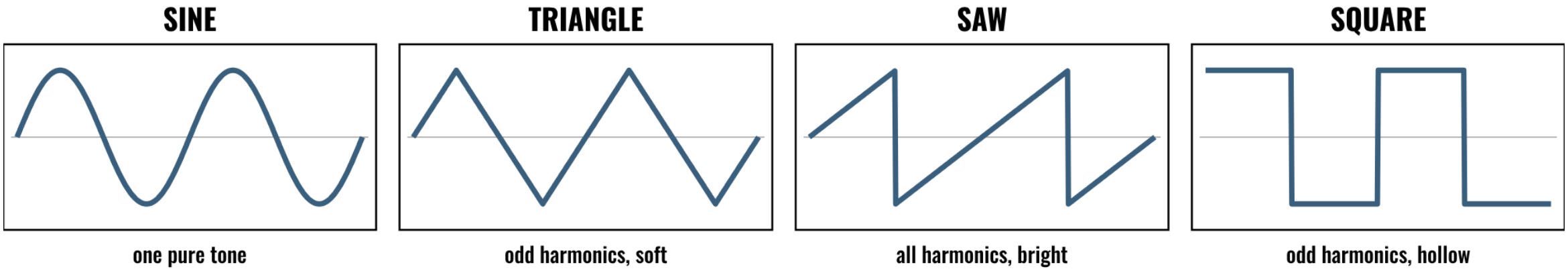
STEPS 1 AND 2: EXPLORE, LEARN

1. Open Alchemy and try the interface
2. Play the sound sources and presets
3. Learn oscillators, filters, envelopes
4. Learn modulation routing
5. Fill in the Explore sheet

START SIMPLE, SAVE OFTEN

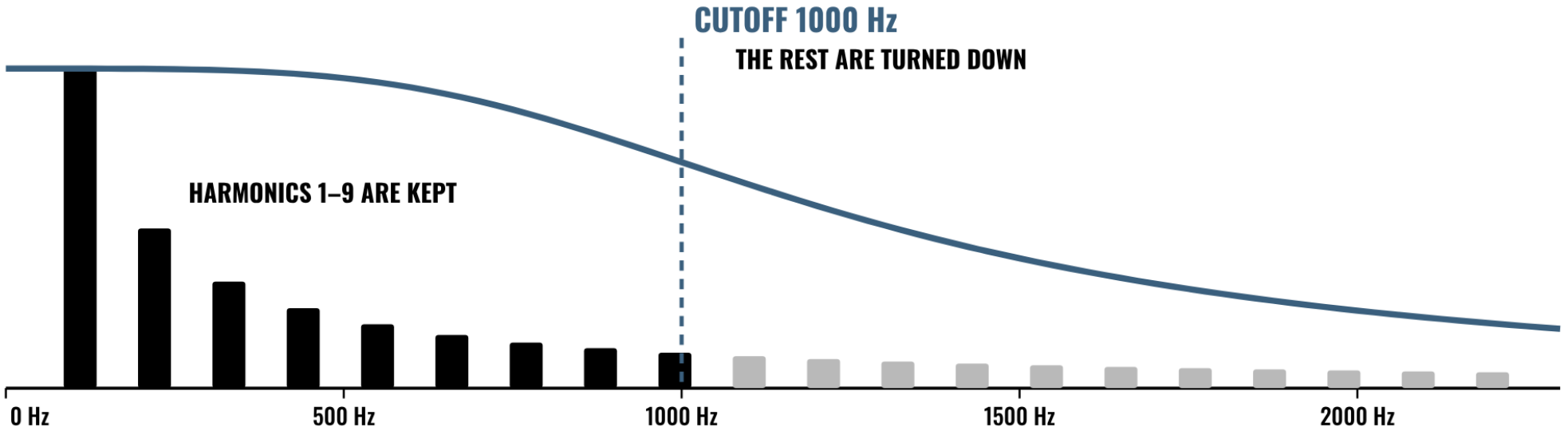
- Simple view before Advanced
- Change one thing at a time
- Save your patch as you go
- Design first, compose second

THE OSCILLATOR: THE RAW SOUND



- Each wave has its own sound
- Square sounds hollow
- Saw is bright, sine is pure
- Start with one and shape it

THE FILTER: SHAPING THE TONE

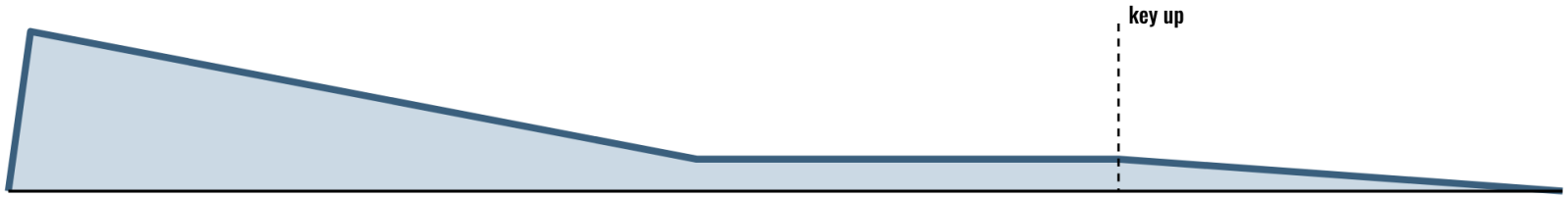


A saw wave at 110 Hz: harmonic k sits at k × 110 Hz, and its level is 1/k

- The filter turns harmonics down
- Open the cutoff to brighten it
- Low cutoff means a darker sound
- Move it while you hold a note

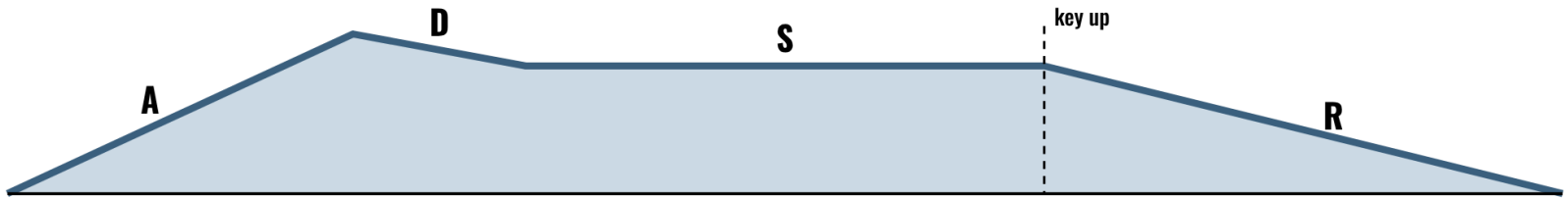
THE ENVELOPE: SHAPE OVER TIME

PLUCK · 0.7 s from key down to silence



A 0.01 s D 0.3 s S 20% R 0.2 s (key held 0.5 s)

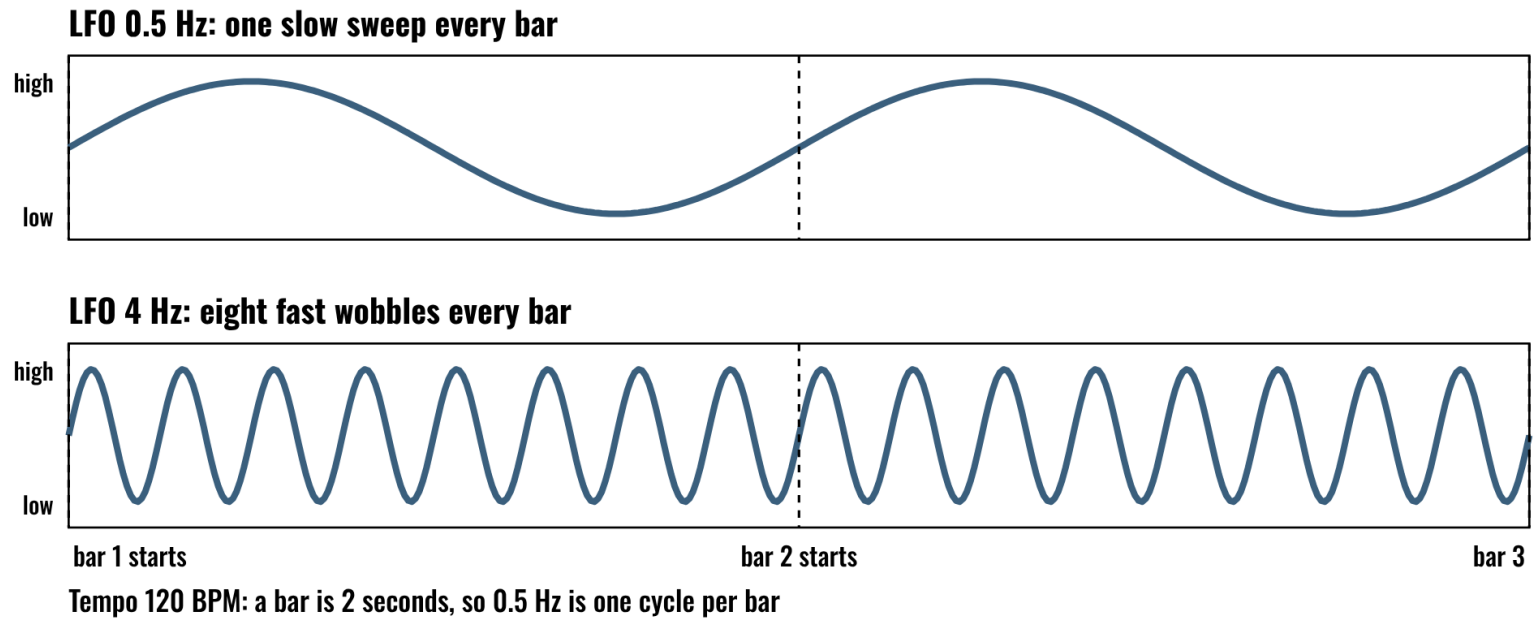
PAD · 4.5 s from key down to silence



A 1 s D 0.5 s S 80% R 1.5 s (key held 3 s)

- Short attack, a pluck
- Release is the tail after you let go
- Long attack, a pad
- Sustain is a level, not a time

MODULATION: MAKE IT MOVE



- An LFO is a slow wave that moves a knob
- Amount sets how far it moves
- Rate sets how fast it moves
- Match the rate to the bar

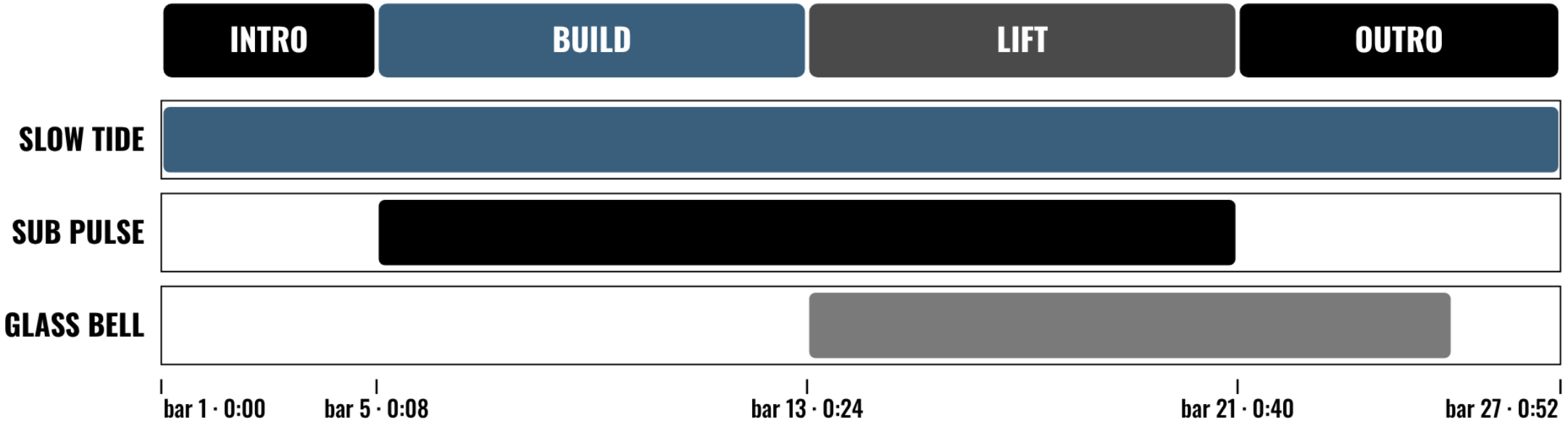
WATCH ME: BUILD PATCH 1

1. Start with one simple waveform
2. Open the filter: move the cutoff
3. Shape it with the envelope
4. Add one slow LFO to the cutoff
5. Save it: give the patch a name

WORKING DAY: PATCHES 2 AND 3

- Build two more sounds from scratch
- Make each one different: bass, pad, lead
- Change one setting at a time
- Save as you go

WORKING DAY: COMPOSE



- Design first, compose second
- Give each patch a job
- Bring patches in and out
- Plan 45–60 seconds

MIX, EFFECTS AND BOUNCE

- Add effects, automation, EQ and panning
- Balance the levels
- Bounce a .mp3 or .wav
- Zip the .logicx project
- Write your 3 Padlet questions

WHAT YOU TURN IN

- [ ] Bounced .mp3 or .wav
- [ ] Zipped .logicx project
- [ ] Named: Your Name – Alchemy Architect
- [ ] 3 custom Alchemy patches made and used
- [ ] Padlet post with your 3 questions
- [ ] Answer 2 questions on classmates' posts

HOW IT'S SCORED

CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	5 = Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive	/ 5
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	5 = Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems	/ 5
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	5 = Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc	/ 5
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	5 = Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix	/ 5
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	5 = Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery	/ 5

SCORED 1–5 · FINAL GRADE = AVERAGE OF YOUR SCORE AND MINE · / 25

PRESENTATION DAY

- Play your track
- Show us your 3 patches
- Your Padlet post: 3 questions about your project
- Answer at least 2 of each classmate’s 3

ONE LAST THING...

- You started with a blank patch.
- You shaped the tone.
- You gave it motion.
- Now the sound is yours.

